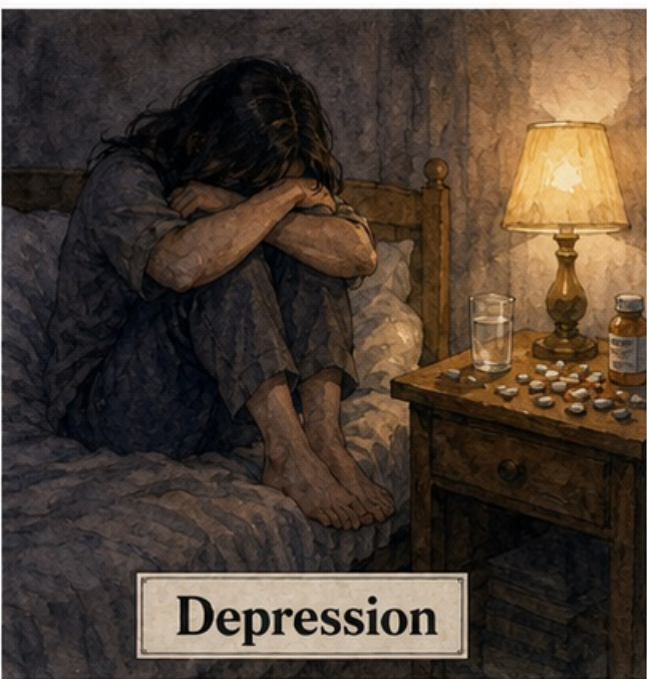
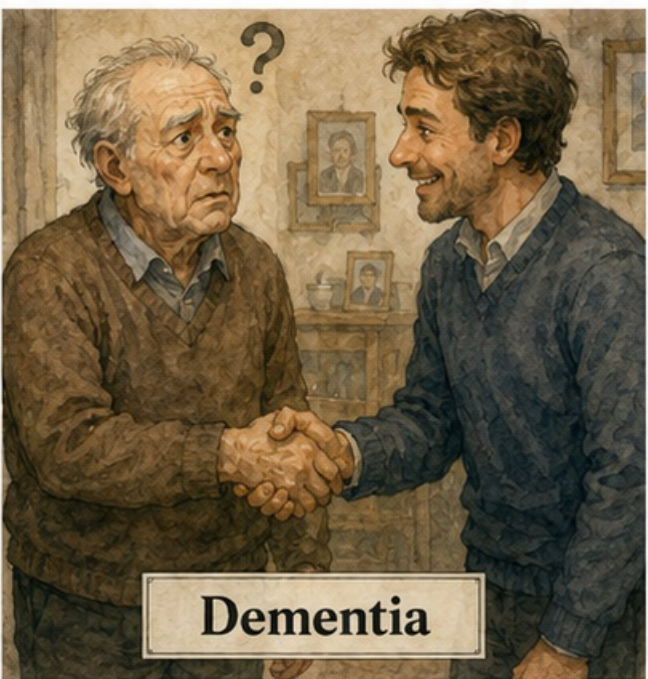
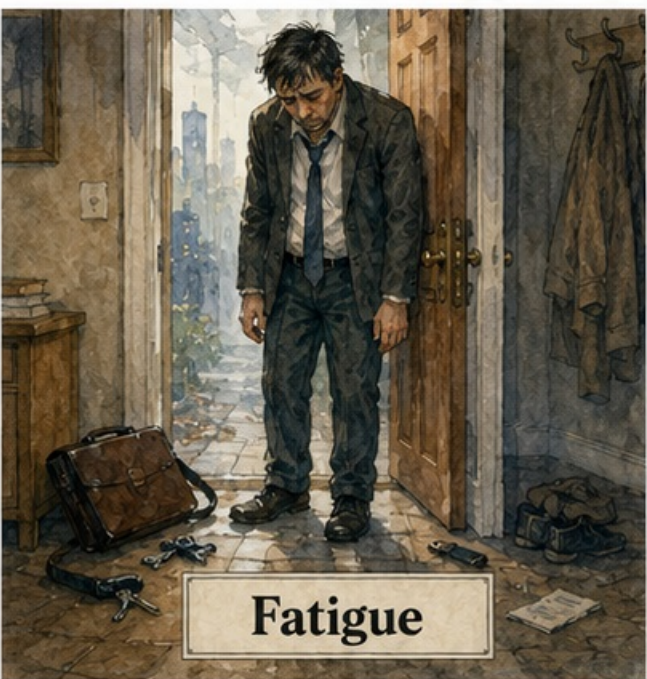
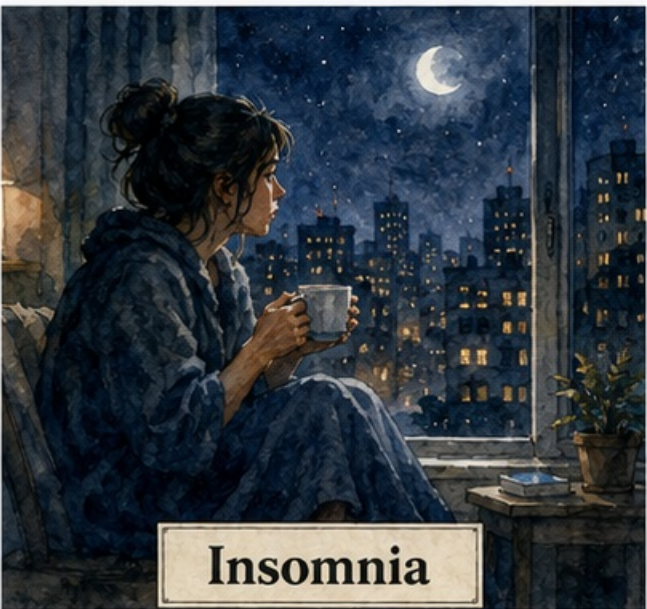
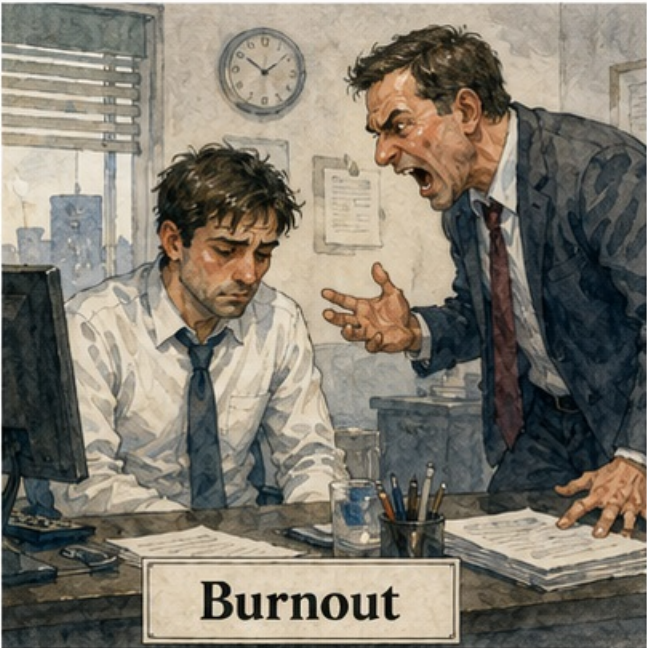


Review these **quality-of-life-altering conditions**. Have you ever faced any of these? What helped you **overcome** them? Rate these conditions from 'bad' to 'the worst imaginable.' Which three would you choose to never experience, and why?



noun	adjective
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- | | |
|-------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. Loneliness — Lonely | 5. Addiction — Addictive |
| 2. Obesity — Obese | 6. Anxiety — Anxious |
| 3. Burnout — Burned-out | 7. Fatigue — Fatigued |
| 4. Insomnia — Insomniac | 8. Dementia — Demented |
| | 9. Depression — Depressive |

Fill in the blanks with the adjective forms:

1. You feel _____ after you hike up that steep hill.
2. My uncle is _____ so he lives in a care home.
3. They look _____ while they work this long shift.
4. She is quite _____ because she eats only fast food.
5. He's been feeling _____ ever since his wife left him.
6. We are so _____ about that huge test tomorrow.
7. Life is _____ since the news broke out today.
8. I am an _____ who keeps awake until the dawn.
9. It is _____ when you play such a silly game.

speaking time

- Is depression an inherited condition or a developed one? Explain.
- What are the primary triggers for anxiety in modern society?
- Is dementia exclusive to the elderly population?
- Has obesity always been a human challenge, or is it a modern phenomenon? Why?
- What are the most common addictions people face these days?
- Statistically, the more populated a city is, the greater the issue of loneliness. Why do you think that is?
- What are the causes of and effective treatments for insomnia?

The Insomniacs

based on a book by Allison Winn Scotch

1 Listen to the four characters describe their lives, then complete the comprehension tasks below each image.



Sybil



Zeke



Julian



Betty

Answer these Yes/No Questions:

1. Does she live with her children now?
2. Does she feel like a hidden ghost?
3. Does she sleep well at the night?
4. Does she enjoy her own silence?
5. Does she love true crime stories?

True/False Statements:

1. He was once a famous athlete.
2. His injury changed his whole life.
3. He loves the quiet in his home.
4. He sleeps soundly in his bedroom.
5. He remembers his injury very often.

Fill in the Gaps:

1. Julian worked in a candy _____.
2. He feels very sad and _____.
3. His apartment feels like a _____.
4. His wife is no longer _____.
5. He walks streets in the _____.

Find the factual error in each sentence:

1. Betty works as a night cleaner.
2. She likes to make many friends.
3. People watched her life in city.
4. She thinks she is very famous.
5. She carries a heavy blue suitcase.

The group started in the **digital shadows** of an online forum for the sleepless. They were four strangers connected only by the blue light of their screens and their inability to find peace. After weeks of digital conversation, they agreed to meet at a small, **greasy-spoon diner** in Manhattan.

Sybil was the one who suggested it. When they finally sat together in a **worn-out booth**, the atmosphere was **thick with tension**. Zeke felt like an outsider, still struggling with his loss of identity, while Julian kept his eyes on his coffee. But Betty, usually so guarded, felt a strange sense of safety with these people. Sybil's warmth, born from her years of mothering, acted as the glue. She turned their shared frustration into a game; they began to share their deepest, most private anxieties.

Over the following months, the diner became their **sanctuary**. They supported each other through real-life crises: Julian's **strained relationship** with his daughter, Zeke's physical therapy struggles, and Sybil's hidden loneliness. They formed a "found family" that the outside world didn't understand. They weren't just insomniacs anymore; they were partners in survival.

Everything **shattered** on a Tuesday. The diner was busy, but Betty's station was abandoned. Her apron was neatly folded on the counter, and her **shift register** was empty. When Sybil, Zeke, and Julian checked the back entrance, they found nothing but a cold, dark alley and a single piece of paper taped to the door. It simply said: RUN. Betty was gone, and with her, the only sense of safety they had ever found.

- Do you ever feel like a ghost in your own home?
- Have you lost a role that once defined your life?
- Do you find comfort in being alone in the night?
- Are you hiding parts of yourself from other people?

2 Read the text on the left and answer the questions:

1. Where did the four strangers first meet to talk?
2. What helped the group share their private worries?
3. How did the diner change for them over time?
4. What sign did the group find at the diner?

Match the bolded words and phrases from the text to the definitions:

1. _____: An old, tired seating area with seats showing heavy usage.
2. _____: A bond between people that is difficult, tense, or broken.
3. _____: A cheap, casual restaurant serving simple, quick hot meals.
4. _____: Broken suddenly and completely, ending a calm or stable state.
5. _____: A safe and peaceful place where one finds comfort and rest.
6. _____: The machine used to record money from a waitress's work shift.
7. _____: Secret online spaces where users hide their true selves.
8. _____: Full of strong, uncomfortable feelings of worry or stress.

3 Listen and answer the questions.

1. Who took the lead when the panic started?
A) Zeke B) Sybil C) Julian
2. What did they pool to start the trip?
A) Money B) Ideas C) Resources
3. Where did the group drive to find her?
A) North B) South C) West
4. What kind of building did they find her?
A) House B) Motel C) Office
5. Who blocked the door to stop her flight?
A) Zeke B) Sybil C) Julian
6. How did Julian make his voice sound then?
A) Loud B) Soft C) Harsh
7. When did the group drive back to city?
A) Dusk B) Noon C) Dawn
8. What were they now instead of strangers?
A) Team B) Foes C) Staff



- Why do you think the group felt safer with each other than with the rest of the world?
- In your opinion, was Betty right to leave without saying goodbye to the group?
- What specific traits or actions allowed Sybil to become the "glue" of the group?
- Do you believe the group's "found family" dynamic would have lasted if the crisis had never happened?

- Have you ever found a sense of belonging in an unexpected place or with an unlikely group of people?
- If you had to start your life over in a new city, what is the first thing you would choose to leave behind?
- Is it easier for you to open up about your anxieties to strangers or to people you have known for a long time?
- In moments of extreme stress, do you tend to face the problem directly or feel the urge to "run" like Betty?